

In the first phase, the communities are using the emulators on the RAN side, but Magma is being inserted with ONAP and Anuket on Kubernetes. Intel's OpenNESS is also coming in, but in general, these are the big new components.

The second phase is bringing in a commercial genome piece. So the RAN side of things is integrated, and then you are going to run a slice through this. This is where the end-to-end network slicing comes in.

And the last phase, which will happen towards the end of the year, is where ORAN comes in. ONAP and ORAN are already deeply integrated with interfaces. "There is a lot of component reuse between projects because these are all microservices, containerised modules, and you can

use them as needed to get a head start. That's already happening says Joshapura.

Priorities

Completing the solution stacks to integrate a fully open networking and edge stack, speeding up the 'backend interior and deployment process' with open compliance; and integrated deployment in vertical markets to start embracing, utilising and building on networking, cloud and edge stacks are seen as the top priorities.

Today, blueprints are fairly mature and have been deployed. "Most of the projects are live in production. The first step is that it needs to happen. In several use cases, the 5G node is now merged from the open-ended interface side

of things. And so Magma itself, as an open mobile packet core in the Q3 time frame, will be fairly mature. The testing of these blueprints should be ready by the end of the year. Till then it is a proprietary mobile packet core. Pretty much everything that is at the higher layers of the stack is mature. The lower layers will stay proprietary, but the disaggregation concept is mature," concludes Joshapura. 

This article is based on the tech talk by Arpit Joshapura, GM, networking edge and IoT, Linux Foundation, at Open Source Conference 2021 (Virtual).

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